

LEILA ESCOBAR-YOMONA

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EDUCATION AND TRAINING

BSc in Biology

Cayetano Heredia Peruvian University (UPCH), Lima, Peru · Completed Dec 2025

- Undergraduate thesis in progress. Full national undergraduate scholarship (Beca 18, Peruvian Ministry of Education).

Primate Research Course

Cocha Cashu Biological Station, Manu National Park — San Diego Zoo Wildlife Alliance Peru · 2024

- Intensive residential training in Neotropical primate ecology, behaviour, conservation, field methods and research design, including round tables with members of the Indigenous communities involved in primate conservation.

Research Experience for Peruvian Undergraduates (REPU) — Ecology cohort

Duke University, North Carolina, USA · 2024

- Competitive research internship placement within a US ecology laboratory.
- Conducted research in fungal genomics under the supervision of Dr. Lotus Logren at the Vilgalys Lab.

Aspire Leaders Program

Aspire Institute (online) · 2022

- Four-stage leadership training for first-generation university students.

PRIMATE RESEARCH AND CONSERVATION EXPERIENCE

Consultant Biologist and Project Lead

Ikama Peru Wildlife Rescue Center, Loreto, Peru · Jun 2026 – present

- Design and lead the ecological assessment determining the suitability of an Amazonian site for the reintroduction of primate species confiscated from the illegal wildlife trade.
- Estimate primate abundance and density through standardized transect surveys; establish botanical plots to characterise vegetation composition, forest structure and potential food resources.
- Translate field results into technical recommendations for project continuation and for local Peruvian authorities.
- Support the socio-ecological components of the project, including surveys of local residents and environmental awareness and education activities.

Undergraduate Thesis Researcher and Former Volunteer

Neotropical Primate Conservation (NGO) & Lab of Socio-ecological Systems, UPCH — Amazonas, Peru · 2025 – present

- Designed and implemented a field study of seed dispersal by *Lagothrix flavicauda* and *Aotus miconax*, two Peruvian endemic species, in montane forest — using diurnal and nocturnal tracking, focal observations and feeding records.
- Volunteer activities: Supported environmental education with Awajun Indigenous communities and urban schools, focused on biodiversity conservation. Contributed to the assessment of wildlife trafficking in Amazonian regions.

Volunteer — Golden Lion Tamarin Monitoring Programme

Associação Mico-Leão-Dourado (AMLD), Rio de Janeiro, Brazil · Jan – Feb 2026

- Participated in long-term monitoring of reintroduced golden lion tamarins (*Leontopithecus rosalia*) through radio-telemetry, direct observation and tracking of individually identified animals.
- Supported agroforestry management, ecotourism and environmental education activities with elementary school groups, within a Portuguese- and English-speaking multidisciplinary team.

Fellow — Primate Research Course

Cocha Cashu Biological Station, Manu National Park, Peru · Oct – Nov 2024

- Conducted an independent pilot study comparing activity budgets and dietary preferences of lactating and non-lactating adult female *Ateles chamek*; developed and applied an ethogram and collected ecological data.

Field Assistant — *Ateles chamek* population monitoring

Amaraakaeri Communal Reserve & SERNANP, Madre de Dios, Peru · Jul – Aug 2024

- Estimated relative abundance and population density of *Ateles chamek* in human-disturbed areas.
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LEADERSHIP AND CONSERVATION ENGAGEMENT

Communications Team Volunteer

Latin American Society of Primatology (SLAPrim) · 2025 – present

- Co-organised and delivered a region-wide social media campaign against keeping primates as pets, with a multi-country Latin American team.
- Currently helping to develop a primate guide for the upcoming Latin American congress (December 2026).

President (2025) and External Relations Secretary (2024)

Ecology, Evolution and Conservation Student Group (GEECO), UPCH · member since 2021

- Designed and led the group's first in-person symposium on ecology and conservation.
- Co-organised the 2025 Peruvian Primate Week, participating in the public Primate Fair and the webinar series.
- Coordinator of the Conservation 101 division (2024–2025) and founder-coordinator of the Primatology division (2026 – present): initiatives sharing the theoretical basis of conservation and current research with students from Peru and other South American universities.

Co-coordinator, Projects Commission

Voices for the Future Peru · 2025 – present

- Co-organised a campaign for the conservation of the coastal lomas of Lima, an endemic ecosystem, combining in-situ restoration efforts with social-media advocacy.
- Previously volunteered with Fridays for Future International, working with activists from several countries through online collaboration platforms.

Research Secretary (Student Representative)

Association of Heredian Students (AECH), UPCH · 2024

- Founded and designed the “Scientific Seeds” mentorship programme, pairing first-year students with senior mentors; served as mentor of the Biodiversity, Ecology & Conservation team the following year (2nd place, poster presentation).
- Organized the 5th Student Scientific Congress (UPCH), collaborating with each Faculty's Student Representatives.

Volunteer Translator, Spanish Translation Team

Climate Science.org, Climate science education platform, online · 2022 – 2023

- Translated climate science educational material from English into Spanish, within an international volunteer team, to make the platform's web and app content accessible to Spanish-speaking audiences.

SKILLS

Coordination and leadership: design and coordination of projects and student initiatives; organization of symposia, congresses and public events; mentoring and programme design; fundraising support; inter-institutional representation; remote fieldwork logistics.

Communication and outreach: scientific communication and writing; environmental education with various audiences; science translation and accessibility (English–Spanish); social media campaigns.

Distributed teamwork: coordination of multi-country, multilingual volunteer teams across time zones; Slack, Miro, Google Workspace and similar collaborative platforms.

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (intermediate)

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND OUTREACH

- Activity patterns and dietary preferences in *Ateles chamek*: a comparative analysis between lactating and non-lactating females at Cocha Cashu, Peru. Poster presentation, Peruvian Primatological Congress, Lima, 2026.
- Patterns and rates of seed dispersal by *Lagothrix flavicauda* and *Aotus miconax* in a montane forest of Amazonas, Peru. Oral presentation, 6th Undergraduate Scientific Congress, Cayetano Heredia Peruvian University, Lima, 2025.
- Introduction to the Study of Primates in Peru. Mini-course organiser and speaker, Natural History Museum, San Marcos National University, Lima, 2025.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

International Primatological Society · American Society of Primatologists · Latin American Society of Primatology (SLAPrim) · Peruvian Primatological Association · Society for Conservation Biology.